

Dairu Liu

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EDUCATION

Nankai University
B.Eng. in Software Engineering

Tianjin, China
Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2027 (expected)

The Affiliated High School of Peking University

Beijing, China

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My primary research goal is to leverage large-scale data to build **generalizable** embodied agents capable of performing diverse real world tasks. I am particularly interested in **Robot Learning** (scaling up robot data, efficient robot learning algorithms, humanoid whole-body control, loco-manipulation) and **Multimodal Reasoning** (agentic perception, cross-modal understanding, long-horizon decision making).

PUBLICATIONS & PREPRINTS

[1] **HumanTracker: Towards Comprehensive and Human-Aligned Motion Tracking Benchmark**

Dairu Liu*, Zekun Qi*, Jiayu Zeng*, Yu Guan, Chenghuai Lin, Xuchuan Chen, Xinqiang Yu, Wen Yao Zhang, He Wang[†], Li Yi[†]

In Submission

- Built a standardized humanoid motion tracking benchmark with **150 hours** of newly captured optical mocap from **24 professional performers**, comprising **24K clips** organized into **4 motion families** for fine-grained diagnosis.
- Proposed **HumanScore**, a preference-aligned reward model trained on **3K pairwise human comparisons**; achieves **0.8834** alignment rate with human judgments, outperforming MPJPE (**0.8164**), and validated on **Unitree G1** real-robot deployment.

[2] **Humanoid-GPT: Scaling Data and Structure for Zero-Shot Motion Tracking**

Zekun Qi*, Xuchuan Chen*, Dairu Liu*, Chenghuai Lin*, Yunrui Lian, Zhikai Zhang, Wen Yao Zhang, Yu Guan, Jilong Wang, Xinqiang Yu, He Wang[†], Li Yi[†]

CVPR 2026 [Project] [Code]

- Introduced **Humanoid-GPT**, a GPT style causal Transformer trained on a **~2B-frame** retargeted motion corpus, distilling hundreds of RL motion experts via DAGger into a single general motion tracker with strong zero-shot generalization on **Unitree G1**.
- Proposed **Harmonic Motion Embedding (HME)** for diversity-aware, distribution-balanced sampling; characterized scaling trends for data and model size and deployed with real-time inference.

[3] **LIMMT: Less is More for Motion Tracking**

Yu Guan*, Zekun Qi*, Chenghuai Lin, Xuchuan Chen, Dairu Liu, Wen Yao Zhang, Jilong Wang, Xinqiang Yu, He Wang[†], Li Yi[†]

ICML 2026

- First data centric study for humanoid motion tracking: **General Quality Selection (GQS)** scores motion along physics feasibility, diversity (HME embeddings), and complexity, then selects compact subsets via complexity-weighted farthest-point sampling.
- Showed a strong less-is-more effect: training on **~3%** of AMASS can outperform the full corpus across trackers (e.g., Any2Track, TWIST2); validated cross-dataset transfer and real-world **Unitree G1** deployment without fine-tuning.

[4] **Thinking with Visual Abstract: Enhancing Multimodal Reasoning via Visual Abstraction**

11 citations

Dairu Liu*, Ziyue Wang*, Minyuan Ruan*, Fuwen Luo, Chi Chen, Peng Li[†], Yang Liu[†]

NeurIPS 2025 Workshop [Paper] [Project]

- Proposed **Visual Abstract Thinking (VAT)**, a reasoning paradigm that replaces verbose verbal CoT with visual abstractions, focusing models on semantic, structural, and geometric cues.
- VAT achieves **+2.21%** average gain over the GPT-5 baseline, exceeding CoT (**+0.96%**); uses only **0.68×** CoT runtime and **0.1×** the tokens of Visual Sketchpad on GPT-4o. RL-trained VAT further gains **+4.52%** on Qwen-2.5-VL-3B.

[5] Evaluating Time Awareness and Cross-modal Active Perception of Large Models via 4D Escape Room Task

Yurui Dong*, Ziyue Wang*, Dairu Liu*, Shuyun Lu*, Xuechen Liu*, Fuwen Luo, Peng Li†, Yang Liu†

In Submission [Paper] [Project]

- Developed **EscapeCraft-4D**, a customizable 4D escape-room benchmark (**66 scenes, 1,032 objects**) incorporating trigger-based audio, misleading auditory distractors, and temporally transient clues for evaluating time-aware multimodal reasoning.
- Introduced 4D specific process level metrics beyond final success rate: **AMR** (Audio Misleading Rate, measuring how often agents are misled by auditory distractors) and **TCSS** (Transient Clue Seeing Speed, measuring how early agents discover irreversibly-disappearing clues), revealing significant modality bias and failures in time-conditioned decision making across Omni models.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, GALBOT IIIS, Tsinghua University Advisor: Prof. Li Yi	Beijing, China Dec. 2025 – Present
Built a large-scale humanoid motion tracking benchmark and proposed a preference-aligned reward model for whole-body control evaluation, addressing the misalignment between kinematic metrics and human perception. [1]	
Research Intern, THUNLP AIR, Tsinghua University Advisor: Prof. Peng Li, Prof. Yang Liu	Beijing, China Apr. 2024 – Present
- Proposed Visual Abstract Thinking, a novel multimodal reasoning paradigm that enhances MLLMs via visual abstraction rather than verbose verbal rationales. [2] - Developed a 4D escape-room benchmark for evaluating time awareness and cross-modal active perception in Omni models. [5] - Exploring self-evolving agents that generalize from weak to strong supervision.	

HONOURS & AWARDS

National Scholarship (Top 0.2%; Undergraduate, 10000CNY)	Sep. 2024
Second Prize, NOIP 2018 (National Olympiad in Informatics in Provinces)	Dec. 2018
Second Prize, CSP-S 2019 (CCF Certified Software Professional)	Dec. 2019

LEADERSHIP & SERVICES

Vice President, Quantitative Finance & Investment Society, Nankai University	Sep. 2025 – Present
Member, University Ski Team, Nankai University	2024 – 2025
Academic Department Vice-Head, Psychology Association, Nankai University	Sep. 2024 – Sep. 2025

SKILLS

Robot Platforms: Unitree G1

Programming: C++, Python, MATLAB, L^AT_EX

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (IELTS 7.0 – L 7.5, R 8.0, S 6.0, W 6.0; CET-6 608)

Interests: Skiing